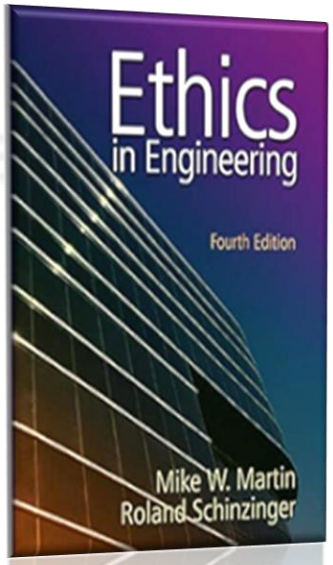
Engineering Ethics (HSS-422) (3+0)



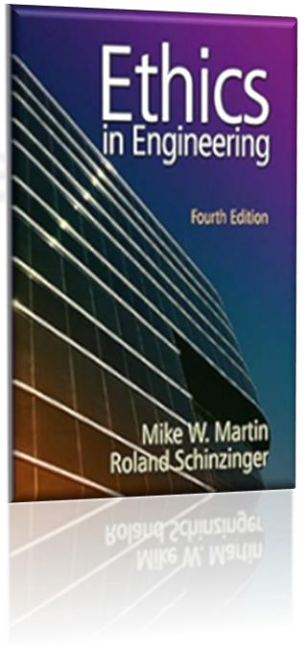




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CASE STUDY - TRANSFORMING ETHICAL DECISION-MAKING IN ORGANIZATIONS

Week No 07

By Engr. Syed Rizwan Ali

Learning Outcomes

In this Lecture will cover ..

- Significant Improvement in Organizational Culture and Ethical Decision-Making Processes.
- Increased Employee Perception of the Company's Ethical Climate.
- Improved Trust and Collaboration with Stakeholders.
- Decrease in Reported Incidents of Unethical Behavior.
- Key Lessons on Leadership and Cultural Change.

CASE STUDY



A Case Study of XYZ Corp's Multifaceted Approach



Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

- **A Case Study of XYZ Corp's Multifaceted Approach**

- **Abstract:** Exploring barriers to ethical decision-making: self-interest, self-deception, fear, ignorance, egocentric tendencies, microscopic vision, uncritical acceptance of authority, and groupthink. Recommendations for fostering ethical awareness.

Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

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Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

- **Introduction:** The significance of overcoming psychological, social, and systemic barriers to ethical decision-making in organizations.
- **Case Description:** XYZ Corp's expansion challenges in the renewable energy sector and the impact of identified impediments on ethical decision-making.
- **Method:** Mixed-methods approach combining qualitative interviews and quantitative surveys to explore the interplay between personal motivations and systemic pressures.

Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

- **Finding:** Key issues include a gap between stated values and behaviors, influence of leadership, and a culture stifling ethical considerations.
- **Solutions and Implementation Plan:** Leadership training, ethical decision-making frameworks, whistleblower policies, culture change initiatives, and their implementation.
- **Results:** Improved organizational culture and ethical decision-making processes, increased employee perception of ethical climate, decreased unethical behavior.

Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

- **Lessons Learned and Future Directions:** Importance of leadership, ethical frameworks, cultural change, and exploring long-term impacts and applicability across industries.
- **Conclusion:** XYZ Corp's journey illustrates overcoming impediments to ethical decision-making through a comprehensive strategy, highlighting the effectiveness of a holistic approach.

Transforming Ethical Decision-Making in Organizations

Questions:

1. What were the primary impediments to responsible action identified in XYZ Corp's case study?
2. How did XYZ Corp approach the challenge of fostering ethical decision-making within its organization?
3. What methodology was employed in the case study to analyze the impediments to ethical decision-making at XYZ Corp?
4. What were the main outcomes of implementing the multifaceted solution at XYZ Corp?
5. What were the key lessons learned from XYZ Corp's implementation of its ethical decision-making strategy?

Case Study 02



Case Study 02: Software Engineering

Title: Impediments to Responsible Action in Software Engineering Ethics
"An ethical dilemma in software security" management.

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- **Introduction:** Software engineers must adhere to ethical principles. However, various impediments hinder responsible action, leading to ethical failures.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

- **Case Scenario: The Compromised Security Patch**

- A cybersecurity company, TechSecure, identifies a critical security flaw in a banking system. However, the management pressures the team to delay the fix to protect business interests.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

Impediments to Responsible Action

1. **Self-Interest:** Profit motives delaying security patches.
2. **Self-Deception:** Downplaying the severity of risks.
3. **Fear:** Employees afraid of job loss if they speak up.
4. **Ignorance:** Junior developers unaware of ethical concerns.
5. **Egocentric Tendencies:** A senior engineer refusing to acknowledge design flaws.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

Impediments to Responsible Action

6. **Microscopic Vision:** Short-term impact prioritized over long-term safety.
7. **Uncritical Acceptance of Authority:** Engineers following unethical directives.
8. **Groupthink:** Collective agreement despite ethical concerns.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

- **Outcome and Consequences**

- Security patch was delayed for three weeks.
- A hacker exploited the flaw, leading to major financial losses.
- The company faced lawsuits and reputational damage.
- Employees who remained silent became complicit in the failure.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

- **Lessons Learned**

1. **Ethical Courage:** Employees should feel safe raising concerns.
2. **Avoiding Self-Deception:** Acknowledge risks honestly.
3. **Challenging Authority:** Question unethical management decisions.
4. **Preventing Groupthink:** Encourage diverse perspectives.
5. **Long-Term Ethics:** Protecting users should outweigh short-term gains.

Case Study 02: Software Engineering

- **Conclusion**
  - Overcoming impediments to ethical decision-making in software engineering requires strong ethical leadership, open communication, and prioritizing responsibility over profit.

Thanks

Any Question

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